

Neha Manohar Bandekar

Senior Financial Analyst | 7+ years

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SUMMARY

Senior FP&A professional with 7+ years of progressive finance experience spanning high-growth business consulting (Cardone Ventures LLC — 2025 Inc. 5000 honoree), public-sector finance, and large-scale Indian banking (Canara Bank, \$40M+ portfolio, 350+ branches). Skilled in multi-business-unit budgeting, driver-based forecasting, cost optimization, and executive reporting — translating complex financial data into decisions for leadership across diverse industries. Targeting Senior FP&A Analyst or FP&A Manager roles combining planning, business partnering, executive reporting, and scalable finance processes.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **FP&A & Budgeting:** Annual Operating Plan (AOP), Long-Range Planning (LRP), Driver-Based Forecasting, Rolling Forecasts, Variance Analysis (BvA), Cash Flow Forecasting, Revenue & Margin Analysis, Scenario & Sensitivity Modeling
- **Strategic Finance & Business Impact:** Business Partnering, Strategic Financial Planning, Decision Support, Pricing Strategy, Profitability & Contribution Margin Analysis, Cost Optimization, Revenue Growth Strategy, Investment Analysis, Capital Allocation, Business Case Development
- **Data Analytics & Reporting:** Advanced Microsoft Excel (Power Query, Power Pivot, VBA, Macros), SQL (Joins, CTEs, Data Extraction), Data Modeling, Dashboard Development, KPI Reporting & Performance Tracking, Predictive & Trend Analysis, Data Validation & Integrity
- **BI & Visualization:** Power BI (DAX, KPI Dashboards, Data Modeling), Tableau, Executive Dashboarding, Automated & Self-Service Reporting
- **AI & Automation in Finance:** Claude, ChatGPT, Google Gemini — applied to rolling forecasts, MoM/YoY variance analysis, revenue projections, scenario modeling, and leadership reporting optimization
- **ERP & Financial Systems:** NetSuite, SAP, Oracle Financials, General Ledger (GL), Financial Consolidation, Multi-Entity & Multi-Currency Reporting, Chart of Accounts (CoA) Structuring
- **Accounting, Compliance & Controls:** GAAP, SOX, Month/Year-End Close, Account Reconciliation, Audit Support, Accrual Accounting
- **Leadership & Execution:** Cross-Functional Leadership, Stakeholder Management, Executive Reporting & Presentations, Strategic Decision-Making, Project Leadership, Change Management, Process Transformation, Mentoring & Team Development

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Financial Analyst – FP&A | Cardone Ventures LLC (Inc. 5000 Honoree, #2,818) Sept 2025 – Present | USA

- Supported FP&A activities across 17 departments within a \$50M annual budget, with direct ownership of 4 departments including 3 business units; aligned resource allocation to strategic priorities and delivered executive-level visibility into revenue drivers, cost structures, and operational performance
- Built driver-based forecasting models integrating revenue, capacity, and cost assumptions across owned business units, improving quarterly forecast accuracy by 18% and enabling rapid scenario evaluation during market shifts
- Leveraged AI tools (Claude, ChatGPT, Google Gemini) to optimize rolling forecasts, accelerate month-over-month and year-over-year variance analysis, and generate leadership-ready insights — reducing report preparation time
- Identified departmental expense inefficiencies and led structured cost optimization initiatives, reducing operating expenses by 12% while maintaining all business performance targets across owned departments
- Designed and built 50+ KPI dashboards in Google Sheets to track performance across owned business units; collaborated with the Power BI team to integrate outputs into enterprise-wide executive reporting workflows, shortening leadership decision cycles by 30%
- Automated financial reporting workflows using advanced Excel and system integrations, eliminating 40% of manual effort and cutting turnaround time for executive-level performance reports

Fiscal Office Specialist – AP Division | Controller's Office, County of San Mateo (Public Sector) Mar 2025 – Jun 2025 | USA

- Managed high-volume AP operations processing 1,000+ invoices monthly; standardized approval workflows, increasing processing efficiency by 35% and reducing delays across multiple departments
- Analyzed AR aging reports and coordinated cross-functional resolution of outstanding balances, accelerating collections by 18% and improving cash flow visibility
- Performed bank and subledger reconciliations, resolving discrepancies within strict close timelines to maintain audit readiness and GAAP compliance
- Supported month-end close by preparing journal entries and validating financial data, contributing to a 3-day reduction in close-cycle timelines

Finance Manager | Canara Bank (Public Sector Banking | \$40M+ Portfolio)

Apr 2021 – Aug 2023 | India

- Oversaw financial performance and reporting for a \$40M portfolio; improved control accuracy by 30% through structured daily cash-flow monitoring and liquidity management processes
- Led annual budgeting and rolling forecast cycles; analyzed cost drivers and reallocated resources, improving forecast accuracy by 15% across operational departments
- Reviewed high-volume financial transactions and enforced accurate revenue recognition and GL postings, reducing transaction discrepancies by 40% through improved validation controls
- Managed reconciliation across customer accounts, resolved complex financial variances, and improved receivable cycles by 20%
- Collaborated with cross-functional teams to enhance financial reporting frameworks and strengthen audit readiness, ensuring full regulatory compliance

Financial Analyst | Canara Bank (Public Sector Banking | 350+ Branch Network)

Aug 2017 – Apr 2021 | India

- Analyzed financial performance across 350+ bank branches using centralized reporting systems; identified cost inefficiencies and implemented data-driven recommendations that improved operational efficiency by 25%
- Conducted ROI and cost-benefit analysis on capital investment initiatives, improving long-term investment efficiency by 20% across infrastructure and business projects
- Prepared monthly financial reports, forecasts, and BvA analysis with high accuracy, improving leadership visibility into performance trends across regional operations
- Developed standardized reporting templates and internal control procedures, enhancing documentation quality and audit readiness across regional finance teams

PROJECTS

AI-Assisted Financial Forecasting & Variance Analysis Platform |

Apr 2026

- Developed an AI-assisted financial forecasting and variance analysis workflow using Claude AI, Excel, and Power BI to analyze financial trends, identify budget deviations, and improve forecasting accuracy
- Built interactive Power BI dashboards integrating financial KPIs, revenue trends, and operational metrics, improving visibility into forecasting performance and reducing manual reporting efforts

Executive KPI & Financial Performance Dashboard |

Feb 2026

- Designed executive-level financial dashboards in Power BI to monitor revenue, operating expenses, profitability, and KPI performance across multiple business units
- Automated monthly reporting workflows by integrating financial datasets from multiple sources, improving reporting turnaround time by 40%

EDUCATION

- MBA, Finance Concentration** | Golden Gate University, San Francisco, CA, USA — Aug 2024
- Bachelor of Laws (LLB)** | Savitribai Phule Pune University, India — Jun 2017

CERTIFICATIONS

- Financial Modeling & Valuation Analyst (FMVA)[®] — Corporate Finance Institute (CFI), Jun 2026
- Post Graduation Diploma in Public Accounting — Nov 2025
- Advanced-Level IRS VITA Certification — Jan 2025